

Chapter 6-1

The ward was very quiet. Xu Qingzhu was drinking water in small sips.

Her posture while drinking was very elegant. You could tell at a glance that she had received proper etiquette training. Her beautiful swan neck was stretched, revealing extremely graceful lines, with sunlight dancing on her skin.

It was a very aesthetic scene.

Liang Shi unconsciously stared in fascination until Xu Qingzhu finished drinking and screwed the cap back on the bottle, placing it on the cabinet. Those eyes looked over coldly: "What are you looking at?"

Liang Shi: "..."

She sheepishly withdrew her gaze.

Liang Shi was not good with words. Even after several years in the entertainment industry, she still maintained a solitary state.

If it weren't for her good acting skills, she really wouldn't have been able to survive in the entertainment industry.

She had always insisted that getting along with people was about exchanging sincerity for sincerity.

So when Sun Chengcheng had been friendly with her initially, she hadn't been overly guarded, never expecting to be betrayed.

Thinking about these things, Liang Shi's mood also became downcast.

For a long time, neither of them spoke.

Finally, it was Xu Qingzhu who broke the silence: "After discharge, I'll have a lawyer prepare the relevant documents. I won't take a cent of your assets. Previously you..."

She paused, her voice becoming colder, yet seemingly forcing herself to stay calm: "The help the Liang family gave to the Xu family..."

Sudden loud and noisy music ringtone interrupted Xu Qingzhu's words.

Liang Shi first looked at her, then belatedly realized it was her own phone ringing.

Liang Shi: "..."

This ringtone was really ugly.

She took out her phone, covered the receiver, bowed slightly to Xu Qingzhu and said: "Sorry."

Then she looked at the screen - it was Cheng Ran.

"Hello." Liang Shi answered, deliberately lowering her voice, "What do you want?"

Cheng Ran's side was a bit noisy, but her voice came through very clearly, quite loud: "Where are you?"

"Hospital." Liang Shi said.

Cheng Ran frowned: "I'm also at the hospital, how come I don't see you? Or maybe..."

She paused, quickly guessing: "You're not in your own ward, you're at Xu Qingzhu's?"

Liang Shi glanced at Xu Qingzhu somewhat guiltily, then immediately said with righteous air: "Yes."

"What for? Going to apologize?" Cheng Ran teased carelessly upon hearing this, "Then I'll come to Xu Qingzhu's now, and take a look while I'm at it."

"Don't come." Liang Shi refused.

"What's wrong? I'm also Xu Qingzhu's friend, right? She's sick, can't I come see her?" Cheng Ran's tone left no room for negotiation, "I came all this way, I can't just leave without doing anything. Why are you so resistant? Could it be... you really want to be a good lover?"

After saying this, she laughed to herself: "Come on, who doesn't know who here."

"Cheng Ran." When Liang Shi called her name, there was a warning tone in her voice.

But Cheng Ran didn't care: "I'll be there soon, come out and meet me."

After saying this, the call was hung up.

Liang Shi looked at the phone screen and frowned, then looked at Xu Qingzhu, finding that she had already turned to face away and was no longer looking at her.

She was worried that Cheng Ran would come to Xu Qingzhu's ward and say something that would stimulate Xu Qingzhu, so she immediately said to Xu Qingzhu: "I have a friend coming to see me, I'll leave first."

Xu Qingzhu didn't respond.

"If you need anything, press the emergency bell." Liang Shi said: "Or call me. Your phone is by your bedside, I helped charge it. Also..."

Liang Shi looked at the phone that had a matching couple case with her own phone, lowering her eyes and saying: "I restored all your data, didn't set a password, you can set it yourself. Also, I deleted all the copied data, including that USB drive that stored your information - I destroyed it. From now on, I won't touch your phone again, and I won't invade your privacy."

The original body had copied all the data to a USB drive after taking Xu Qingzhu's phone. During the waiting time outside just now, Liang Shi had thought of this and went to find a phone store outside to get this done quickly. She was also afraid Xu Qingzhu would be disgusted, so she bought her a new phone.

"There's also a completely new, unopened phone. If you don't want to use the old phone, you can insert your SIM card and use the new phone." As Liang Shi spoke, she could already hear the clicking sound of high heels in the corridor. She guessed it was also Cheng Ran.

Someone who could walk around the hospital in sky-high heels - there was no one else but her.

Liang Shi immediately cut to the chase: "Take good care of yourself. I'll leave first and come see you later."

After saying this, she hurried out of the ward.

The moment she left the ward, Xu Qingzhu, who was lying on the bed, opened her eyes.

She hadn't been asleep.

She had heard everything Liang Shi said.

Moreover, she had good hearing since childhood. She had also heard what Cheng Ran said on the phone.

Not only that, she had also heard all those frivolous, contemptuous things Liang Shi had said about her to others before.

She just hadn't said anything.

Because the Xu family was on the verge of bankruptcy, it was Liang Shi marrying her that injected a considerable amount of funds into the family, thus saving the company. So she knew she was indebted and endured it every time.

Moreover, she had good feelings toward Liang Shi.

In her memory, Liang Shi had always been that girl who, even when kidnapped, would bravely seek opportunities for survival and encourage her to escape together, not like now - cynical, arrogant, willful, and promiscuous.

But memories don't change, people do.

Liang Shi was no longer what she remembered.

When lying on the bed suffering from her heat period, she finally saw clearly.

Even if Liang Shi was now saying she wouldn't hurt her and making repeated assurances, and even if her behavior had improved, she would no longer trust Liang Shi.

She just wanted to divorce Liang Shi.

Then join the company to help her father. She had an MBA degree, but her father had always been worried about her health and hadn't let her get involved in company affairs.

Just as Xu Qingzhu was thinking, her phone vibrated.

【Mom: Baby Zhuzhu, has your sister contacted you?】

Xu Qingzhu frowned: 【No.】

Xu Qingzhu had a sister named Xu Qingya, 15 years old this year, just starting high school, at the rebellious age of adolescence.

Before she got married, Xu Qingya often quarreled with their parents at home, and she was caught in the middle as a mediator.

When she got married, Xu Qingya cried her heart out and promised her that she would obediently listen to their parents from then on.

This promise had been effective for four months.

At least, this was the first time since her marriage that her mother had contacted her asking about Xu Qingya's situation.

She replied: 【No.】

【Mom: Yaya quarreled with your dad again. Your dad threw away all of Chen Zhengxuan's¹ merchandise and tore down all the posters in her room. She got so angry that she ran away from home. Your dad's stubborn temper also flared up, and he froze her card. She should contact you. When she does, take care of her and also try to persuade her.】

Xu Qingzhu: 【Okay.】

She was mentally and physically exhausted now, but still forced herself to call Xu Qingya.

No one answered.

She called again, and it had already become a busy signal.

Switching back to the screen, her mother sent a message: 【How are you and Shi getting along?】

Xu Qingzhu's finger stayed on the screen, not knowing how to respond for a moment.

A clear tear fell on the pillow.

She started typing: Mom, I plan to divorce Liang Shi

Before she finished typing, a message appeared at the top of the screen: 【The Liang family is powerful and has helped us. Be nicer to Shi. She might have been spoiled since childhood and has a bad temper, but she's not a bad kid.】

Xu Qingzhu: ...

That's because you haven't seen her vicious side.

【Mom: The company situation doesn't seem very good recently. Your dad is very tired every time he comes home. Just you two being well is enough.】

Xu Qingzhu deleted everything she had typed. Thousands of words turned into just one character: 【Okay.】

Footnotes:

¹ Chen Zhengxuan (陈征洵) - Appears to be a celebrity or idol that Xu Qingya is a fan of